



Devoted to the Soil



Who was George Washington Carver?

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He was a teacher, a scientist and an inventor. Carver discovered hundreds of uses for peanuts, soybeans and sweet potatoes. Carver was devoted to the soil.

George was born into enslavement in the 1860s. When enslavement ended, George was able to access an education. He was interested in science and he went to university to become a botanist. He studied the science of plants.

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George devoted his life to inventing useful products by using plants like peanuts and sweet potatoes in his research.

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George invented more than 300 products from peanuts, including paints, oils and soaps. He invented other products from sweet potatoes, including postage-stamp glue, flour, and vinegar.

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George worked hard to discover ways in which to improve soils that were depleted by repeated cotton plantings. George discovered that if farmers planted a crop with lots of protein, the soil nutrients that the cotton plants needed would return.

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He encouraged African American farmers to plant soya beans, sweet potatoes and peanut plants every other year to keep the soil healthy. George developed a crop rotation method.

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Crop rotation is used by farmers all over the world today. Carver was a revolutionary African American agricultural chemist and experimenter. He was devoted to the soil.

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